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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (Honours)/MGU-BBA (Honours)/MGU-BCA (Honours)

REGULAR EXAMINATION, MARCH 2025

SECOND SEMESTER

Ability Enhancement Courses (AEC) –

MG2AECENG101 - ENGLISH FORARTS AND HUMANITIES - PART II

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

SCHEME OF VALUATION

Part A

MCQ

Answer all questions. Each question carries 1 mark. **[1x5 = 5]**

1. Which sound pair distinguishes words like "fail" and "veil"? [U] / [CO1]

a). /s/ and /ʃ/ **b). /f/ and /v/**

c). /k/ and /g/ d). /tʃ/ and /dʒ/

Answer: b). /f/ and /v/

2. What is the significance of reviewing notes after a lecture? [U] / [CO2]

a). It improves retention and understanding of the material.

b). It helps memorise lectures verbatim.

c). It allows students to rewrite everything neatly.

d). It reduces the need to listen attentively in class.

Answer: a). It improves retention and understanding of the material. [U] / [CO3]

3. Identify the passive voice form of the sentence "Someone stole my phone."

a). **My phone was stolen**. b). My phone is stolen.

c). My phone was being stolen. d). My phone had stolen.

Answer: My phone was stolen

4. What technique did Martin Luther King Jr. use in his "I Have a Dream" speech? [K] / [CO2]

a). Humour b). Storytelling

c). **Flourish** d). Silence

Answer: Flourish

5. Which of the following phrases can be used to confirm understanding during a call? [A] / [CO3]

a). "Let's just move on."

b). "So, if I understand correctly, you're saying [rephrase the information]."

c). "I'll think about that later."

d). "Why do you keep repeating yourself?"

Answer: b). "So, if I understand correctly, you're saying [rephrase the information]."

Part B

SHORT ANSWER

Answer any 6 questions. Each question carries 5 marks. [5x6 = 30]

6. How does listening support professional success? Provide real-life examples where effective listening has helped in your day-to-day life. [U] / [CO1]

Answer: improves understanding; decision making; aids problem solving; supports professional success; develops effective communication skills.

Marks to be given for the points showing how-- and for at least one real-life example (preferably 2.5 = 2.5 marks)

7. Propose a strategy to handle interruptions or distractions during a presentation. [U] / [CO2]

Answer: Any intelligent strategy/strategies including the possibility of reserving interactions for a specific part of the presentation.

8. Explain how you will respond to the following question in a job interview. “Describe your past experience in team work.” (Share an experience where teamwork led to success, your role in the team, and how you contributed to achieving the goal.) [A] / [CO3]

Answer: Any positive description of the previous experience (teamwork)

9. How can one decline a request politely? Give examples. [U] / [CO1]

Answer: depending on the person and the context adopt a formal or informal tone -- use expressions showing politeness -- apologise

10. Explain the role of evidence in supporting arguments in a debate. Provide examples of different types of evidence. [U] / [CO2]

Answer: Debate is a battle of brains – logic in connecting ideas is the core strength of the arguments in a debate – evidences strengthen the argument. (any answer demonstrating this function can be given full marks). At least one example needs to be included to get more than 3 marks.

11. Prepare answers to the following questions asked in a telephonic interview for the post of a supervisor in a company. “How would you describe your ideal work environment?” “Do you have any questions for us regarding the role or the company?” [U] / [CO3]

Answer: The answer to the first question can ideally connect the respondent's aspirations with the company's values, emphasizing how they align.

The second question offers an opportunity for the respondent to indirectly highlight, by asking questions, positive qualities -- by expressing a desire to contribute to the organization."

12. What are the key elements of small talk? Explain with examples. [U] / [CO1]

Answer: The answer has two parts:

The elements: casual and informal –light and not deeply personal –to initiate communication and build rapport -- (page 11-12). (2.5 marks)

This is to be explained with one or two examples like those given in the text. (2.5 marks)

13. Compare and contrast signpost expressions used for transitioning between points and those used for summarizing key ideas. Provide examples to highlight their differences. [A] / [CO2]

Answer: (page 49-51)

Those that transition between points -- introduce a point; signal that you finish one point and move on to the next – Such as, 'I would like to move on to', and similar ones.
Those that summarise ideas give a list if this comes towards the end: like 'finally, to sum up. . .' and 'The main take away is. . .' etc.,
Brief explanation based on the examples would be ideal.

14. Write a conversation where a person calls a plumbing company to book an appointment for a repair. The receptionist should ask for details and confirm availability. [A] / [CO3]

Answer:

A telephonic conversation demonstrating proper telephone etiquette from the persons calling and answering the call– (Page no 101) – purpose of the interaction should be well expressed in the answer.

Part C

ESSAY

Answer any 1 question. Each question carries 15 marks. [15x1 = 15]

15. Discuss the key factors that make directions effective. Imagine your friend is visiting your city for the first time. Write a detailed set of directions to guide her from the railway station to your home. [U] / [CO1]

Answer: Key factors: Clarity –simplicity –polite and friendly –checking for understanding (getting feedback) – landmarks (pages 18 and 19) --

A good direction will be landmark-based, mentioning directions; distance and time needed to cover the distance – sequentially. The conversation needs include them.

16. Prepare a speech to persuade your college to implement a plastic-free campus policy. [A] / [CO2]

Answer: in the speech, look for cause effect relationship in the argument – Good speech to include anecdotes/ sayings/quotes/personal examples and testimony/statistics facts and data – they would also be having catchy beginnings and have the ability to attract the listener. (pages 58-59)
Assess the overall quality of the answer and award marks accordingly.

17. Imagine that you have a master's degree and a Ph.D. in English language and literature. Prepare a cover letter and a resume for applying for the post of Assistant Professor of English at Jawaharlal Nehru College, Thiruvananthapuram. [A] / [CO3]

Answer:

The cover letter to include the following in the order given below:
name and address of the sender, date in proper format, Name and address of the employer, Subject line, salutation, body, complimentary close, enclosures. The body to express interest, highlight relevant skills and achievements, -- should tailored to the post of assistant professor, and suit the institution. (Pages 89-93)

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Resume: to complement the details given in the cover letter – name and address – career objective – education, professional experience, key skills, projects and achievements, certification and training, languages proficient in, references (page 94,95)